

3D-PAWS as a Baseline Tier Observing Network

- **3D-PAWS should be defined as a baseline tier observing network**

Three Tiers as defined by WMO*

- Reference
 - Highest level of performance
 - Appropriately calibrated
 - Uncertainty estimates included in observations
- **Baseline (3D-PAWS)**
 - **Managed network (by local Met Services)**
 - **Quality Controlled (at COMET and CHC)**
 - **Conforms to WIGOS Metadata Standards (location, elevation, instrument types, observation schedule, exposure information)**
- Comprehensive
 - Little management
 - No quality control
 - Can be crowd-sourced

Also from Vision 2040

Users can decide whether or not to use observations, and how to use them for a given application area, based on the tier to which the observing platform belongs. For instance, when monitoring the onset of active severe weather, timeliness and spatial and temporal resolution are more important than low uncertainty of measurements, and a comprehensive network is desirable. For detailed monitoring of long-term trends in temperature or background atmospheric composition, the converse is true, and observations from a reference network may be required.